

BASIC HR POLICY DOCUMENT

For Startup / Early-Stage Companies

Prepared for CodeAlpha Human Resource Management Internship

1. PURPOSE & SCOPE

This HR Policy Document establishes clear guidelines for leave management, professional conduct, and work-from-home practices. It applies to all full-time employees, interns, and contractual staff working with the organization. The policy aims to create a fair, transparent, and productive workplace while supporting employee well-being and organizational growth.

2. LEAVE POLICY

2.1 Types of Leave

Casual Leave (CL): 12 days per calendar year. Can be used for personal reasons, short emergencies, or family matters. Maximum 3 consecutive days without prior approval from reporting manager.

Sick Leave (SL): 10 days per calendar year. Medical certificate required for absence exceeding 2 consecutive days. Unused sick leave does not carry forward.

Earned / Privilege Leave (EL/PL): 15 days per year after completion of 6 months of continuous service. Can be accumulated up to 30 days. Requires minimum 7 days prior written notice.

Maternity Leave: 26 weeks as per applicable law for female employees who have completed 80 days of service.

Paternity Leave: 5 working days for male employees (to be availed within 30 days of childbirth).

2.2 Leave Application Process

- All leave requests must be submitted via email or HR portal at least 3 working days in advance (except emergencies).
- Reporting manager approval is mandatory before leave is considered sanctioned.
- In case of sudden illness or emergency, inform the manager within 2 hours of the start of the working day.
- Unapproved absence of more than 2 consecutive days may be treated as leave without pay (LWP).

2.3 Public Holidays

The company will declare a list of 10–12 public holidays at the beginning of each calendar year, aligned with national and regional holidays. Employees working on a declared holiday will be eligible for compensatory off or overtime as per company rules.

3. CODE OF CONDUCT

All employees are expected to uphold the highest standards of integrity, professionalism, and mutual respect. This Code of Conduct outlines the behavioral expectations that create a positive and ethical workplace.

3.1 Professional Behavior

- Treat colleagues, clients, and partners with respect, courtesy, and fairness at all times.
- Maintain confidentiality of company information, client data, and employee personal details.
- Avoid any form of discrimination, harassment, bullying, or offensive language (including on digital platforms).
- Dress in a neat and professional manner appropriate to the work environment (business casual for office / neat attire for video calls).
- Use company resources (laptop, software, internet) only for legitimate business purposes.

3.2 Integrity & Ethics

- Do not engage in any activity that creates a conflict of interest with the company's business.
- Never accept or offer bribes, kickbacks, or inappropriate gifts from vendors or clients.
- Report any unethical behavior or policy violation to HR or management immediately.
- Protect intellectual property and do not share proprietary code, documents, or strategies externally.

3.3 Digital & Communication Etiquette

- Respond to official emails and messages within a reasonable timeframe during working hours.
- Use professional language in all written and verbal communication.
- Do not post confidential company information or negative remarks about the organization on social media.
- Camera-on is preferred during important meetings unless bandwidth or personal constraints exist.

3.4 Disciplinary Action

Violation of this Code of Conduct may result in verbal warning, written warning, suspension, or termination, depending on the severity and frequency of the offense. Serious misconduct (theft, harassment, data breach, violence) may lead to immediate termination and legal action.

4. WORK-FROM-HOME (WFH) GUIDELINES

The company supports flexible work arrangements to enhance productivity and work-life balance, provided business needs and team collaboration are not compromised.

4.1 Eligibility & Approval

- WFH is available to all employees after successful completion of the probation period (unless role requires on-site presence).
- Employees must obtain prior approval from their reporting manager for regular WFH days.
- Hybrid model (e.g., 3 days office + 2 days WFH) may be defined by the team lead based on project requirements.

4.2 Working Hours & Availability

- Core working hours: 10:00 AM – 6:00 PM (or as agreed with manager). Employees must be available during these hours.
- Status must be updated on communication tools (Slack/Teams) – Available / Busy / Offline.
- Attend all scheduled meetings on time. Inform in advance if unable to join.

4.3 Productivity & Accountability

- Maintain the same level of output and quality as expected in the office.
- Submit daily/weekly status updates as required by the team process.
- Ensure a quiet, professional background during video calls and minimize distractions.
- Protect company data: use secure Wi-Fi, lock devices when unattended, and never share credentials.

4.4 Equipment & Support

The company will provide a laptop and necessary software licenses. Employees are responsible for maintaining a reliable internet connection (minimum 20 Mbps recommended). Any hardware issues must be reported to IT/Admin promptly.

4.5 Review of WFH Arrangement

WFH privileges may be reviewed or revoked if performance declines, communication becomes inconsistent, or business needs require greater on-site presence. The decision rests with the reporting manager and HR.

5. POLICY REVIEW & AMENDMENTS

This policy will be reviewed annually or as needed to reflect changes in law, business requirements, or best practices. Employees will be notified of any significant amendments. The company reserves the right to modify this policy at its discretion.

Document prepared for CodeAlpha Internship – Human Resource Management Module

This is a sample policy framework suitable for startups and early-stage companies. Customize as per your organization's specific needs and local labor laws.

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